

BROKILD · WINDOWS VST3 · OVERDRIVE

BattleStar *OVERDRIVE*★

OPERATOR'S HANDBOOK

BUILD 260926.2



Eight drive engines, a tube that tells you which one you are on, and a tank that runs dry if you play too long. Built with Max Christensen, for the band of the same name. **September 2026.**

WHAT THIS IS

A BATTLESTAR OVERDRIVE FOR BATTLESTAR OVERDRIVE

I suggested to make a VST3 for Max, and he asked for a Battlestar Overdrive, named after his solo band. That was too good not to do. So here it is, built with his blessing.

Battlestar Overdrive is Max Christensen, out of Copenhagen, and it crash-lands somewhere between a late-night discotheque and a sweaty basement venue: garage rock swagger welded to soul, disco and slacker electronica. He takes the stage alone, with a mashed-up rig of synths, sequencers and samplers and a screen of zany visuals behind him. It is bonkers, it is hyper-charged, and it is unreasonably optimistic about it. **Go and listen to it.** This plugin makes more sense afterwards, and so, probably, does everything else.

Eight drive engines on one knob, running from a polite tube to a fold-crush-chaos cascade with no musical justification whatsoever; a CRT that tells you which one you are on, speeds its starfield up as you climb, goes to warp on the seventh and blows up a star on the eighth. SPACE flies through no less than five different FX, because too much is never enough.

It is very good at ruining things, beautifully and thoroughly.



The eighth engine. SUPERNOVA. The star ahead of you swells, reddens, shudders, and then does not survive it.

IN SHORT

Six knobs, one button, one screen. Everything is on the front and everything does something. Turn it up and find out which.

FOR THE MISFITS, THE OUTSIDERS, AND ANYONE READY TO RIDE A WAVE OF SPACE-TRAVELLING ROCK 'N' ROLL.

EVERYTHING IS ON THE FRONT



Left, top to bottom: Mix, Thrust, Antithrust. **Right:** Engine, Space, Spectrum. Below the tube: the fuel gauge and the Autorefill button.

INSTALLING

Copy **Battlestar Overdrive.vst3** into your VST3 folder — normally `C:\PROGRAM FILES\COMMON FILES\VST3` — and rescan in your DAW. The standalone in the same download needs nothing installing; double-click it.

THE FIRST MINUTE

Put it on a guitar, a drum bus or a whole mix. Turn **Thrust** up until it stops being polite. Turn **Engine** until you find the one that suits the damage you want. Everything else is taste.

THE TUBE IS THE READOUT

There are no numbers printed on the metal. Touch a knob and its value appears on the glass in blue, then fades. The instrument only ever speaks inside the screen.

THRUST & MIX

THRUST

HOW HARD YOU DRIVE IT

Gain into the engine. Every engine is **level-matched** by a table the plugin measures for itself when it starts, so turning THRUST up changes what it sounds like without simply making it louder. Six of the eight engines sit inside 4–6 dB across the whole sweep; the two folders are wider, because a wavefolder's loudness genuinely depends on what you feed it and no honest compensation can pretend otherwise.

MIX

DRY AGAINST EVERYTHING ELSE

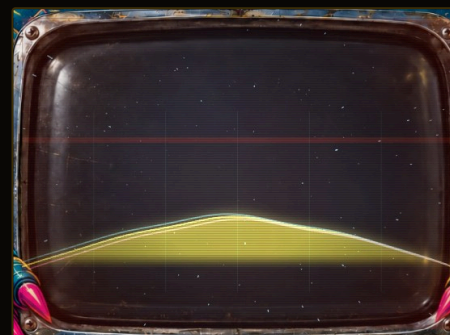
A plain linear blend, and the dry path is delayed to match the processed one sample for sample — so at MIX 0 what comes out is what went in, measured to zero difference, with no comb and no phase smear. Park it around three quarters for parallel dirt under an intact transient.

PARALLEL IS WHERE IT LIVES

It is usually more useful to wreck the signal completely and blend it back than to half-wreck it. Drive hard, then ride MIX.



Touch a knob and the tube says what it is set to, in blue, for a second. Then it goes back to the starfield.



Clipping. When the output is genuinely running out of room the tube blooms red and the raster tears. The green curve keeps tracking gain as it always did — the warning is the picture around it.

ENGINE

Eight of them, ordered from polite to unhinged, because that is what putting them on one knob promises.

1	IDLE BURN	Soft asymmetric tube. Warmth and a second harmonic. The one you leave on.
2	ION DRIVE	The classic soft knee. Transparent until pushed, then obliging.
3	PLASMA COIL	Tape saturation with memory — it remembers the last thing you hit it with.
4	AFTERBURNER	Asymmetric fuzz, squashed. Where it starts sounding like a decision.
5	RAZOR WING	Tanh into a hard clip. Flat-topped and mean.
6	WARP FOLD	A wavefolder. Past a point, louder stops meaning brighter and starts meaning stranger.
7	HYPERDRIVE	Harmonic injection — Chebyshev, so it adds harmonics that were never in there.
8	SUPERNOVA	Fold, crush and chaos. No musical justification is offered or implied.

THE KNOB IS STEPPED

It lands on one of eight, and the tube names it in blue for two seconds. So you can change engine mid-take and read what you landed on without looking away from the screen.



Every engine announces itself. Held, then it brightens and goes.



HYPERDRIVE, the seventh. The stars stop being points and stretch into lines.

ANTITHRUST & SPECTRUM

ANTITHRUST

WIDTH, AFTER THE DAMAGE

Distortion is the enemy of a stereo image: two slightly different signals through two shapers make wildly different harmonics and the picture smears. So ANTITHRUST works **after** the drive, and it only ever **adds** decorrelated width derived from the middle of the signal — it never touches the middle itself.

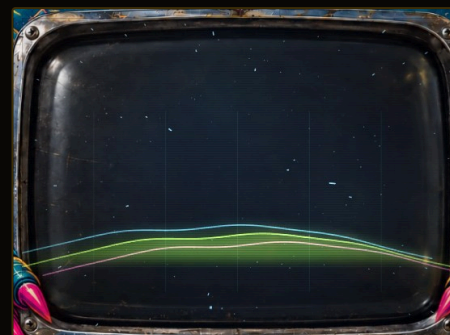
Two things follow from that, and both are measured. Whatever the knob is doing, **the mono sum is unchanged** (0.02 dB across the whole sweep), so nothing collapses on a club system or a phone. And an incoming stereo image survives: what arrived is passed through and only added to, never replaced.

At zero it is ordinary stereo and completely out of the way.

SPECTRUM

ONE KNOB, THE WHOLE TONE STACK

Counter-clockwise is mid-focused with the highs rolled off and the bass tucked in. Noon is flat-ish with the mids just starting to scoop. Clockwise is scooped mids with the bass and treble up — about 20 dB of swing between the middle and the two ends, and normalised so it changes the tone rather than the loudness.



ANTITHRUST up. The response curve splits into a ghosted pair — the two sides of the image pulling apart. At zero they sit exactly on top of one another.

MONO-SAFE, NOT LEVEL-FLAT

Adding decorrelated width genuinely raises total energy. The only way to hold the level perfectly while widening is to pull the middle down — which is exactly what breaks the mono sum. This one picks mono, and caps the width so the rise reads as **bigger** rather than louder.

SPACE

Five effects on one knob, overlapping, so there is no point where one stops and the next begins. Too much is never enough.

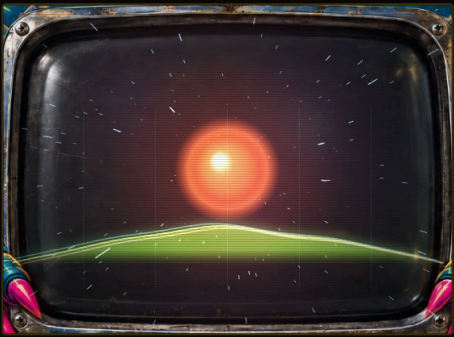
WHERE THE KNOB IS	WHAT IS HAPPENING
Off	Nothing. Exactly nothing — the whole section is bypassed.
Early	Tape delay. The time traces 30 ms out to 600 and back to 30 again in a single arch, so the knob passes through the useful range instead of ending on it. Feedback climbs to about half.
Middle	A large hall fades in underneath and its decay grows as you go.
Three quarters	Shimmer. An octave folds back into the room. The hall shortens as it comes up — a six-second tail has no loop gain left to lend.
Late	Harmonic tremolo. The band splits at 800 Hz and the halves sway against each other in opposite phase. It stops pretending to be a room at all.
Top	Vibrato, true pitch, arriving last and on top of everything already happening.

IT IS MIXED, NOT ADDED

The wet path is blended in rather than piled on top, so turning SPACE up does not simply make everything louder and hotter into the ceiling. If you want more or less of the whole section than the knob gives you, that is what **SPACE WET** is for — see page 9.



SPACE paints. Turn it up and translucent nebulae drift across the tube, changing colour and shape with the setting.



Meanwhile, on SUPERNOVA. The reddening runs ahead of the swelling, so the star has gone ugly well before it goes.

FUEL

WATCH THE FUEL.

You don't want to run out. Thrust me.

The **Autorefill** button is lit by default, and while it is lit there is nothing to think about.



Full.



Getting low.



Dry.



Told you.

AUTOMATION & THE TWO CONTROLS WITH NO KNOB

Everything on the metal is a host parameter and automates normally. Two more exist that the panel has no room for — the decal came first and nothing was allowed to need a control the metal does not have — so they live in your DAW's automation list only.

SPACE WET

OVERALL LEVEL OF THE SPACE SECTION

Bipolar about the centre. **Centre is exactly what SPACE does on its own**, so leaving it alone changes nothing. **Zero** shuts the whole section off however far SPACE is turned up. **Maximum** is the same journey, wetter.

SPACE SYNC

LOCK THE DELAY TO THE HOST

FREE • 1/1 • 1/2 • 1/4 • 1/4T • 1/8D • 1/8 • 1/16

On **FREE** — the default — the delay sweeps with the SPACE knob as described on page 7. Choose a division and it locks to the transport instead. Engaging it snaps rather than glides, because gliding into a new delay time lands the first echo early.

NOT SEEING THEM?

A plugin instance already sitting in a project keeps the parameter list it was created with. Drag in a fresh one, or rescan your plugins, and both appear.

MEASURED

Oversampling	4x, always
Worst-case aliasing	−99.8 dB
Oversampler flatness	±0.002 dB to 19 kHz
Noise floor	−221 dBFS
Mono sum vs ANTITHRUST	0.02 dB
Level drift after a step	0.00 dB
MIX 0 against the input	exact
CPU	~2.5 % of one core
Latency	reported to the host

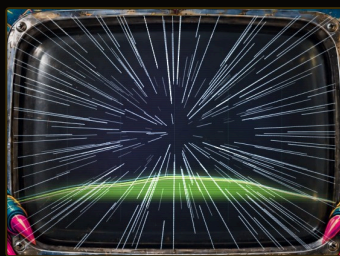
NO WORLD RACK HERE

The Brokild World FX rack is in the synths. This is an effect and you already have a chain — it stays out of it.

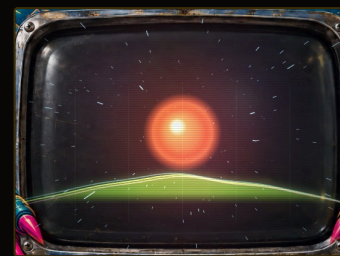
WHAT THE SCREEN IS TELLING YOU



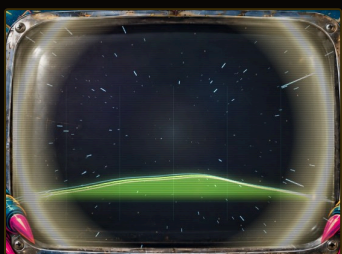
Speed is the engine. The starfield crawls on IDLE BURN and accelerates with every step up the knob.



Seven is warp. HYPERDRIVE stretches the stars into streaks.



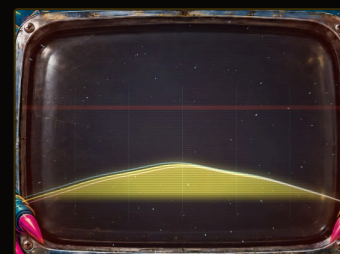
Eight is worse. On SUPERNOVA a star sits ahead of you and slowly stops being well.



And then it goes. The shock front is drawn as light rather than as a circle someone drew.



SPACE paints fog. Colour and shape follow the setting.



Red is a warning. Hard clipping blooms the tube and tears the raster.

THE GREEN CURVE

Along the bottom of every one of these runs the response curve, tracking the gain you apply in real time — the one thing on the tube that is an instrument rather than a view out of a window. It swells as THRUST comes up and splits into a ghosted pair as ANTITHRUST widens.



THE TRANSMISSION

Something is coming through from a long way off. Push the output towards clipping and it comes in clearer.

SIX SETTINGS

None of these is correct. They are just places the knobs have been where something good happened.

ALWAYS ON

IDLE BURN · Thrust 30 · Mix 100 · Spectrum 50 · everything else off. A little weight and a second harmonic. Leave it across the bus and forget it.

GARAGE GUITAR

AFTERBURNER · Thrust 65 · Spectrum 30 · Antithrust 20 · Space 15. Mids forward, a slap of room, just enough width to stop it sitting in the middle of your head.

DISCO DRUM BUS

PLASMA COIL · Thrust 45 · Mix 70 · Spectrum 68 · Antithrust 35. Parallel, so the transient survives. The scoop makes room for everything else.

THE VOCAL THAT SHOULD NOT WORK

RAZOR WING · Thrust 55 · Mix 45 · Spectrum 42 · Space 30. Flat-topped and nasty underneath a clean take. Ride MIX, not THRUST.

SYNTH, RUINED

WARP FOLD · Thrust 80 · Spectrum 75 · Space 55 · Antithrust 60. The fold makes harmonics that were not there and the hall makes them somebody else's problem.

TOTAL LOSS

SUPERNOVA · Thrust 100 · Space 85 · Antithrust 70 · Autorefill OFF. Runs for about a minute and then dies in front of you. Record the whole thing.

SET THE ENGINE FIRST

They differ in character far more than in amount. Picking one before you start turning THRUST saves you finding the same sound eight times.

MIX IS THE REAL DRIVE

It is usually more useful to wreck the signal completely and blend it back than to half-wreck it. Ride MIX and leave THRUST where it bites.

CREDITS

GO AND LISTEN TO THE BAND

Battlestar Overdrive is Max Christensen, out of Copenhagen. Garage rock swagger welded to soul, disco and slacker electronica, performed alone on a mashed-up rig of synths, sequencers and samplers, with a screen of zany visuals behind him.

Eclectic, wildly entertaining, and the reason this plugin exists. The idea was his and so was the blessing. The damage is yours.

Put the band on. Then come back and turn ENGINE all the way up.

BROKILD

Free, and free to pass on.
peterboggild.github.io/BrokildApps

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FUEL NOT INCLUDED

